

SENATE JOINT RESOLUTION 567

By Powers

A RESOLUTION to honor the memory of Representative Jeff Burkhart of Clarksville.

WHEREAS, we were greatly saddened to learn of the untimely passing of our colleague Representative Jeff Burkhart of Clarksville, a lifelong Tennessean who believed strongly in the power of service, love, and dedication; and

WHEREAS, a two-term member of the House of Representatives, Jeff Burkhart ably represented the good people of Montgomery County during his sadly short time in the General Assembly, which included the 113th and 114th General Assemblies; and

WHEREAS, born in Clarksville on March 16, 1962, Jeff Burkhart was the son of John Dewey "J.D." Burkhart and Jane Griffy Burkhart; he was a graduate of Northwest High School and earned an associate's degree in fire science from Volunteer State Community College; and

WHEREAS, a lifelong resident of Montgomery County, Representative Burkhart was a dedicated public servant for more than four decades, beginning with Clarksville Gas & Water in 1982 before embarking upon a distinguished career of nearly twenty-two years with Clarksville Fire Rescue, where he rose to the rank of Assistant Fire Chief; and

WHEREAS, a highly successful small business owner, Representative Burkhart was a member of the Clarksville Home Builders Association; he served as president of the Tennessee Home Builders Association in 2015 and was inducted into the Tennessee Home Builders Hall of Fame in 2021; and

WHEREAS, seeking elective office to further serve his community, in 2009, Jeff Burkhart began a twelve-year tenure as a member of the Clarksville City Council, representing Ward 12, during which time he served as chair of the Gas & Water and Finance committees; and

WHEREAS, his service to the Clarksville and Montgomery County communities included service as a board member of the Clarksville Department of Electricity and the Montgomery County Education Foundation and as an advisory board member for the Sexual Assault Center; and

WHEREAS, in November 2022, Jeff Burkhart was first elected to the House of Representatives of the 113th General Assembly to represent the 75th House District; Representative Burkhart worked tirelessly to advocate for his constituents, earning the respect of both his colleagues and the communities he represented; and

WHEREAS, his commitment to public service and his dedication to improving the lives of his fellow Tennesseans ensured his legacy as a leader who worked with integrity and compassion; and

WHEREAS, Representative Jeff Burkhart rendered sterling service as a member of the House Commerce Committee, the House State and Local Government Committee, the House Local Government Committee, the House Transportation Committee, the House Business and Utilities Subcommittee, the House Public Service Subcommittee, the House Department and Agencies Subcommittee, and the House Campaign Finance Subcommittee; and

WHEREAS, Representative Burkhart cherished being a son, father, brother, and fiancé, and his family was his greatest joy; he is survived by his beloved daughter, Meredith Burkhart, and his devoted fiancée, Cindy Greene, who was the light of his life and closest companion, and her son, Noah Greene; and

WHEREAS, he will be mourned but fondly remembered by his siblings, Phillip (Virginia) Burkhart and Lisa (Jeff) Fenoseff; nieces and nephews, Justin Butts, Jeremy (Hannah) Burkhart, Ben (Brianna) Burkhart, Brittini (Tyler) Tracy, Morgan (Dylan) Stewart, Hunter Burkhart, and Lexie Chapman; and a host of extended family members, colleagues, and dear friends; and

WHEREAS, in addition to his parents, he was preceded in death by his nephew, Jordan Butts; and

WHEREAS, Representative Burkhart touched many lives through his kindness, wisdom, and commitment to making Tennessee an even better place, and he will be fondly remembered for his warm and generous spirit; and

WHEREAS, for too few years, Jeff Burkhart was a vital member of this body, and his passing leaves a void in his community and this State that will not be easily filled; now, therefore,

BE IT RESOLVED BY THE SENATE OF THE ONE HUNDRED FOURTEENTH GENERAL ASSEMBLY OF THE STATE OF TENNESSEE, THE HOUSE OF REPRESENTATIVES CONCURRING, that we honor the memory of our colleague Jeff Burkhart, reflecting fondly upon his numerous contributions to good government in Tennessee and his legacy of effective public service in his community.

BE IT FURTHER RESOLVED, that we express our sympathy and extend our condolences to Representative Burkhart's family and many friends.

BE IT FURTHER RESOLVED, that an appropriate copy of this resolution be prepared for presentation with this final clause omitted from such copy and upon proper request made to the appropriate clerk, the language appearing immediately following the State seal appear without House or Senate designation.